

Building Greener, Smarter Cities:

KONE's Vision for a Sustainable Urban India

India's cities are expanding rapidly, and this swift pace of urbanization brings many opportunities. As the country aspires to become a developed nation by 2047 under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's *Viksit Bharat* vision, the need to grow responsibly and sustainably has never been more important. KONE India, under the leadership of Managing Director Amit Gossain, is helping to shape this transformation by redefining how urban spaces move—safely, intelligently, and with minimal environmental impact. KONE's presence in India spans nearly four decades, beginning in 1984. Today, it is the country's leading elevator company, headquartered in Chennai with over 5,800 employees across 60+ branches. Its Chennai facility not only serves the domestic market but also exports to neighboring countries such as Bangladesh, Nepal, Bhutan, and Sri Lanka. The city is home to three KONE training centers and one of its eight global R&D hubs, where engineers are shaping the future of vertical mobility.

At the heart of KONE's efforts is a simple yet powerful principle: innovation should serve both people and the planet. The company has committed to significant climate targets, including reducing greenhouse gas emissions from its products and energy use by 40%, and cutting emissions from its own operations by 50% by 2030. These goals have been validated by the Science Based Targets initiative, giving them global credibility and ensuring they are aligned with international climate standards.

This commitment extends beyond products and operations. KONE is actively engaged in environmental CSR initiatives across India, partnering with communities and local authorities to support ecological restoration projects. These include water body rejuvenation programs, afforestation drives, and environmental awareness campaigns

that aim to promote a greener tomorrow for future generations.

A shining example of KONE's operational commitment to sustainability is its state-of-the-art manufacturing facility in Sriperumbudur, Tamil Nadu, which is certified as a carbon-neutral site. This factory is not only a hub for producing energy-efficient equipment for India and neighboring countries, but also operates with renewable energy sources, efficient water management systems, and responsible waste practices. The facility stands as a benchmark in sustainable manufacturing and reflects KONE's leadership in clean and green operations. KONE's dedication to sustainable innovation is reflected in its cutting-edge solutions. Its elevators and escalators are among the most energy-efficient globally, having achieved 23 top-tier A ratings for energy performance. A standout example is KONE UltraRope®, an advanced hoisting technology that reduces energy consumption by 15% on high-rise elevator journeys. KONE also pioneered machine room-less elevators, which significantly reduced the space and energy typically required for elevator systems. Additional features such as regenerative drives and LED lighting enable energy savings of up to 90% compared to conventional systems. These green innovations help developers meet stringent environmental certifications like LEED and BREEAM, while advancing toward net-zero objectives. Beyond energy efficiency, KONE focuses on long-term environmental responsibility. Its products are designed with durability in mind, lasting over 25 years and supporting circular economy principles by keeping materials in use longer and reducing lifecycle waste. Through its Environmental Excellence Program, KONE is also enabling cities to evolve into smart, low-carbon communities filled with energy-efficient buildings.

This commitment to innovation and public well-being was especially evident during the COVID-19 pandemic. In response to new health and safety needs, KONE introduced a series of features to make shared spaces safer—ranging from touchless elevator operation via WhatsApp to air purifiers using NASA-developed technology that eliminate viruses and bacteria. Escalators were equipped with UV-C sanitizers to disinfect handrails without the use of chemicals. At the same time, KONE's 24/7 Connected Services platform ensured real-time elevator monitoring using cloud technology, enhancing reliability when it was most needed.

This strong foundation has been recognized globally. KONE was awarded the EcoVadis Platinum Medal, placing it in the top 1% of companies worldwide for sustainability. It also earned a place on the Carbon Disclosure Project's A List for climate action. Additionally, KONE has developed 23 elevator models with the highest A-class energy efficiency rating under ISO 25745, along with eight escalator and autowalk models rated at the top A+++ level.

KONE's long-term vision is clear: to build cities where people can move efficiently, safely, and sustainably. As urban landscapes evolve, so too must the technologies and values that support them. By focusing on collaboration, continuous innovation, and environmental stewardship, KONE is not only adapting to change—it is driving it.

As Amit Gossain puts it, "Through collaboration, innovation, and a shared commitment to sustainability, we can build a future where construction activities harmonize with the environment."

One elevator, one innovation, and one sustainable step at a time—that's how KONE is helping build tomorrow's cities today.